

Bazaar

The latest and greatest products put through the grinder to tell you what's best

**Smart lamp posts in Chicago**

Researchers are adding sensor-equipped lamp posts to track air quality, noise levels and wind on the streets <http://digit.in/SmartLampPosts>

IMAGING: BALJUN NV



Thin 'n' light wonders

It doesn't get any better than thin 'n' light laptops when it comes to portable computing. A device with ultraportability, looks and performance to handle your computing needs. But which one's right for you?

Anirudh Regidi
anirudhregidi@digit.in

Using an equestrian analogy, you might be forgiven for thinking that a regular laptop is a workhorse and the Ultrabook the show pony, but you'd be wrong. An Ultrabook is more than just a device for show; it's a slim, sleek

and light device that is generally quite stylish, but more importantly powerful enough to handle most of your computing needs. What's not to like?

The advances that Intel has made to processor architectures (with Haswell), is, arguably, single-handedly responsible for the Ultrabook as we know it today. Even one year ago it would have been quite a task to

create a laptop that was slim and powerful and offered excellent battery life. If anything, the slimness of the design went against the Ultrabook concept because you'd end up with a sleek and powerful device that was only capable of lasting a couple of hours or more, and toasted your lap at the same time.

An Ultrabook promises the ultimate in portable computing,

form and function. We focused on Ultrabooks priced around ₹1 lakh and come away quite impressed by the devices on offer. We were pleasantly surprised to find the performance characteristics to be quite similar (though the prevalence of the i5 4200U might have something to do with that) and we ended up focusing on features and usability to a larger extent.